

SMIC (0981.HK): 3Q26 GM guidance beat; ASP improvement continued; 2Q26 strong beat; Buy

2Q26 Revenues of US\$3.0bn (+36% YoY/ +20% QoQ) beat GSe/Bloomberg consensus, and came in better than management's guidance of +14~16% QoQ. 2Q26 GM of 25.3% was higher than our/Street expectations of 21.0%/21.4%, and higher than the management guidance range (20%–22%). The sequential revenue growth was supported by the increase of wafer shipments and ASP; management attributed the GM improvement to product mix and higher ASP. **3Q26 guidance in line:** 3Q26 revenues guided to be +2%–4% QoQ, in line with GSe/Bloomberg consensus of US\$3.02bn/US\$3.06bn; 3Q26 GM guidance was 26%–28%, beating GSe and consensus (22%/22%). **We maintain our Buy rating on SMIC: we are positive on the company's long-term growth driven by local fabless customers' growing demand and AI-related opportunities.** Read more in our [CHIPS-Act 3 report](#); [SMIC upgrade](#).

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Exhibit 1: SMIC 2Q26 result snapshot

(US\$m)	2Q26 Actual	2Q26 GS	Diff	2Q26 Con.	Diff	1Q26	QoQ	2Q25	YoY
Revenue	3,006	2,887	4%	2,858	5%	2,505	20%	2,209	36%
Gross profit	761	607	25%	612	24%	504	51%	450	69%
Operating income	552	353	57%	333	66%	248	123%	151	266%
Pre-tax profit	810	354	129%	331	145%	255	217%	160	405%
Net income	479	285	68%	251	91%	197	143%	132	262%
EPS	0.06	0.04	68%	0.03	76%	0.02	143%	0.02	261%
Margins									
Gross margin	25.3%	21.0%	4.3ppts	21.4%	3.9ppts	20.1%	5.2ppts	20.4%	4.9ppts
Operating margin	18.4%	12.2%	6.2ppts	11.7%	6.7ppts	9.9%	8.5ppts	6.8%	11.5ppts
Net margin	27.0%	12.3%	14.7ppts	11.6%	15.4ppts	10.2%	16.8ppts	7.3%	19.7ppts

Source: Company data, Bloomberg, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

2Q26 GM/ NI beat

- Revenue of US\$3.01bn (+20% QoQ, +36% YoY) was higher than the company's guidance (+14~16% QoQ), and 4%/5% higher than GSe/consensus of US\$2.89bn/US\$2.86bn.
- GM was 25.3%, (up from 20.1% last quarter), which was higher than GSe (21.0%) and Bloomberg consensus (21.4%), and beat company guidance (20%-22%).
- Opex ratio was 6.9%, better than GSe (8.8%) and consensus (9.7%), leading to operating profit of US\$552mn, 57%/66% higher than GSe/consensus estimates. We attribute the higher OP to GM improvement and management's effective expense control.
- Net profit was US\$479mn (+143% QoQ, +262% YoY), better than GSe of US\$285mn and consensus' US\$251mn.
- Capacity increased to 1.097mn wafer per month (wpm) by 2Q26 in 8" equivalent, vs. 1.08m wpm by 1Q26; UT rates sustained at 93.7%, vs. 93.1% in 1Q26.

Exhibit 2: SMIC's 3Q26 guidance

(US\$m)	Guidance	GS	Consensus
Revenue	+2~4% QoQ (US\$3066m~3,126m)	3,022	3,060
Gross margin	26%~28%	22.2%	22.1%

Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research, Bloomberg

3Q26 guidance Rev in line; GM beat

- **3Q26 Revenues to increase 2%-4% QoQ**, in line with GSe/Bloomberg consensus of US\$3.02bn/US\$3.06bn.
- **3Q26 GM guided to be 26%-28%** (vs. 25.3% in 2Q26), beat GSe (22.2%) and consensus (22.1%).

Price Target Risks and Methodology - SMIC

Valuation methodology: We are Buy rated on SMIC A/H. Our 12-m target price for the H-share is **HK\$135.0** and is based on an 80.3x 2028E P/E, discounted back to 2026E with a COE of 15%. Our target multiple is based on SMIC's EPS growth relative to peers' P/E vs. EPS growth correlation. Our 12-m target price for the A-share is **Rmb243.4** and is based on a 196% premium over the H-share that is in line with the avg of SMIC's A/H

premium since Jan 2024.

Key risks: 1) Weaker-than-expected demand in smartphones and consumer electronics; 2) Slower-than-expected product diversification and capacity expansions; and 3) Access to certain equipment/material supply may be restricted as the company is on the US BIS Entity List.

0981.HK	12m Price Target: HK\$135.00	Price: HK\$67.55	Upside: 99.9%
688981.SS	12m Price Target: Rmb243.40	Price: Rmb129.44	Upside: 88.0%

Buy		GS Forecast			
Market cap: HK\$540.5bn / \$68.9bn Enterprise value: HK\$709.8bn / \$90.5bn 3m ADTV: HK\$10.6bn / \$1.4bn China Greater China Technology M&A Rank: 3 Leases incl. in net debt & EV?: No	Revenue (\$ mn)	12/25	12/26E	12/27E	12/28E
	EBITDA (\$ mn)	9,326.8	11,578.5	13,869.2	16,753.0
	EPS (\$)	4,919.9	6,418.7	7,673.1	9,044.6
	P/E (X)	0.09	0.15	0.20	0.28
	P/B (X)	81.5	58.2	43.6	30.2
	Dividend yield (%)	2.6	3.0	2.8	2.6
	N debt/EBITDA (ex lease,X)	0.0	0.0	0.0	0.0
	CROCI (%)	1.4	1.0	1.0	0.8
	FCF yield (%)	7.5	8.5	8.9	9.3
		(7.1)	(2.8)	(3.6)	(1.1)
	EPS (\$)	3/26	6/26E	9/26E	12/26E
		0.02	0.04	0.04	0.05

Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Research estimates, FactSet. Price as of 13 Aug 2026 close.

Disclosure Appendix

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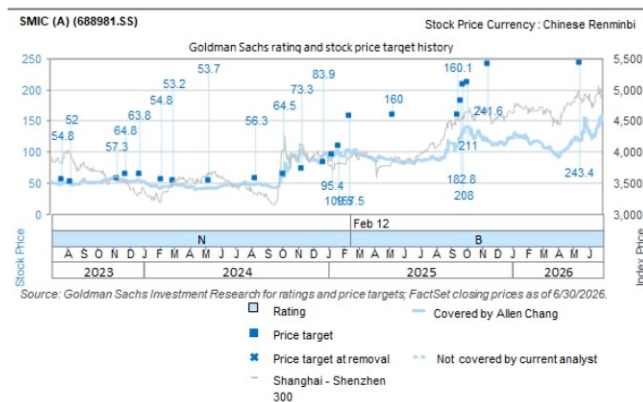
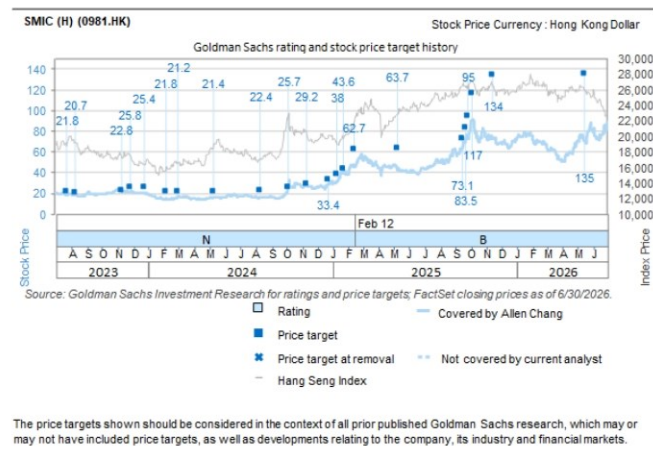
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Price target and rating history chart(s)



Target price history table(s)

SMIC (A) (688981.SS)

Date of report	Target price (Rmb)	Closing price (Rmb)
15-May-26	243.40	119.02
14-Nov-25	241.60	118.18
05-Oct-25	211.00	140.13
26-Sep-25	208.00	132.27
22-Sep-25	182.80	128.92
15-Sep-25	160.10	108.66
10-May-25	160.00	85.83
12-Feb-25	157.50	104.32
22-Jan-25	109.50	100.24
09-Jan-25	95.40	91.32
23-Dec-24	83.90	95.18
10-Nov-24	73.30	100.30
06-Oct-24	64.50	59.99
12-Aug-24	56.30	48.78
10-May-24	53.70	42.99
02-Mar-24	53.20	48.51
06-Feb-24	54.80	44.97
26-Dec-23	63.80	51.85
28-Nov-23	64.80	54.55
10-Nov-23	57.30	54.39

SMIC (H) (0981.HK)

Date of report	Target price (HK\$)	Closing price (HK\$)
15-May-26	135.00	71.15
14-Nov-25	134.00	73.50
05-Oct-25	117.00	90.90
26-Sep-25	95.00	72.95
22-Sep-25	83.50	73.35
15-Sep-25	73.10	63.00
10-May-25	63.70	43.00
12-Feb-25	62.70	47.95
22-Jan-25	43.60	42.10
09-Jan-25	38.00	31.45
23-Dec-24	33.40	29.10
10-Nov-24	29.20	28.55
06-Oct-24	25.70	27.35
12-Aug-24	22.40	16.54
10-May-24	21.40	16.26
02-Mar-24	21.20	17.04
06-Feb-24	21.80	15.34
26-Dec-23	25.40	20.15
28-Nov-23	25.80	22.75
10-Nov-23	22.80	21.80

Price targets shown in table(s) are unadjusted for corporate actions.

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